

PHISHING EMAIL DETECTION & AWARENESS REPORT

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INTRODUCTION

Phishing is a social engineering attack where attackers impersonate trusted organizations to trick users into revealing sensitive information such as passwords, banking credentials, or personal data. These attacks commonly use fraudulent emails containing malicious links or attachments.

The purpose of this assessment is to analyze a phishing email sample, identify phishing indicators, classify its risk level, and provide awareness recommendations to help users recognize and avoid phishing attacks.

EMAIL SAMPLE OVERVIEW

Subject: Urgent: Your Account Will Be Locked

Sender: security@secure-account-verify.com

Embedded Link: <http://secure-account-verify.com>

The email claims that suspicious activity has been detected on the recipient's account and requests immediate verification to prevent account suspension.

RISK CLASSIFICATION

Parameter	Classification
Email Type	Phishing
Severity	High
User Impact	Credential Theft
Overall Risk	High

PHISHING INDICATORS IDENTIFIED

- **SUSPICIOUS SENDER DOMAIN**

The sender domain is not associated with any recognized or trusted organization. Legitimate companies typically use official domains.

- **URGENCY TACTIC**

The email pressures the recipient to take immediate action by claiming that the account will be suspended.

- **SUSPICIOUS LINK**

The verification URL appears unrelated to any legitimate service and cannot be trusted.

- **GENERIC GREETING**

The message uses “Dear User” instead of the recipient’s actual name.

- **FEAR-BASED LANGUAGE**

Threats such as account suspension are used to create panic and encourage impulsive actions.

URL INSPECTION RESULTS

The embedded URL was inspected using a web browser.

Result:

- The website returned a Cloudflare Error 522 (Connection Timed Out).
- The website was inaccessible.
- The domain appeared suspicious and unverified.

This behavior further increases the likelihood that the email is malicious.

PREVENTION GUIDELINES

Users should follow the following practices:

- Verify sender email addresses carefully.
- Never click links from unknown sources.
- Hover over links before opening them.
- Confirm urgent requests through official communication channels.
- Use multi-factor authentication whenever possible.
- Report suspicious emails to the IT or Security team.

EMPLOYEE DO'S AND DON'TS

Do's

- Verify sender identities.
- Check domain names carefully.
- Report suspicious emails.
- Use strong passwords and MFA.
- Follow company security policies.

Don'ts

- Do not click suspicious links.
- Do not open unexpected attachments.
- Do not share passwords or OTPs.
- Do not trust urgent requests without verification.
- Do not provide personal information through email links.

CONCLUSION

The analyzed email exhibits multiple phishing characteristics including a suspicious sender domain, urgency tactics, generic greetings, suspicious URLs, and fear-based language. Based on the findings, the email is classified as a High-Risk Phishing Email and should not be trusted. User awareness and proper verification procedures remain critical defenses against phishing attacks.